THE VENOMOUS ABYSS · HEROIC · FINAL BOSS

Ula'tek

Pull review: Tuesday 21 October 2026

10	35.0%	4 of 10	0
pulls, 21:12 to 22:35, all wipes	best pull (P8): Stage Three, third platform, 530 s	pulls reached Stage Three	pulls lost to Heart targeting

The short version

- **Heart targeting is mostly fine.** Ten of the fifteen players who cast damage spells in the windows aimed 90% or more of their casts at the Venomous Heart while it was exposed. The damage lost to body hits is **at most 0.7–1.4% of her health per window**, and that ceiling counts every cleave proc as a mistake. Three players spent whole windows on the body: **Pawsey, Littlemel and Hyperxd**. That is worth fixing, but it didn't cost you any of the ten pulls.
- **Avoidable damage is steady, not spiky.** The raid takes about 3.1 personal avoidable hits per player per 10 minutes alive. That rate barely changed across the night, so there is no bad pull to point at. Tanks top the table for positional reasons (see section 3). Among everyone else, **Pawsey** stands out, and so does **Fartshart** with Virulent Spit, which is a killing blow in Stage Two because it lands on top of Blight Vein.
- **None of the ten wipes was caused by Heart targeting or general dodging.** They come from three places. **Stage Two**: Grasping Fangs snaps chained too close together (Blight Vein reached 5–6 stacks in P5 and P10), and Vipers hatched (P4, P7). **Serpent's Bite circles were left short of soakers** after earlier deaths or a group mix-up (P2, P8, P9). **Tank hand-offs left her or her tail with nobody in reach** (P1, P6, plus seven Unchecked Rage and four opening Rattler Slams).

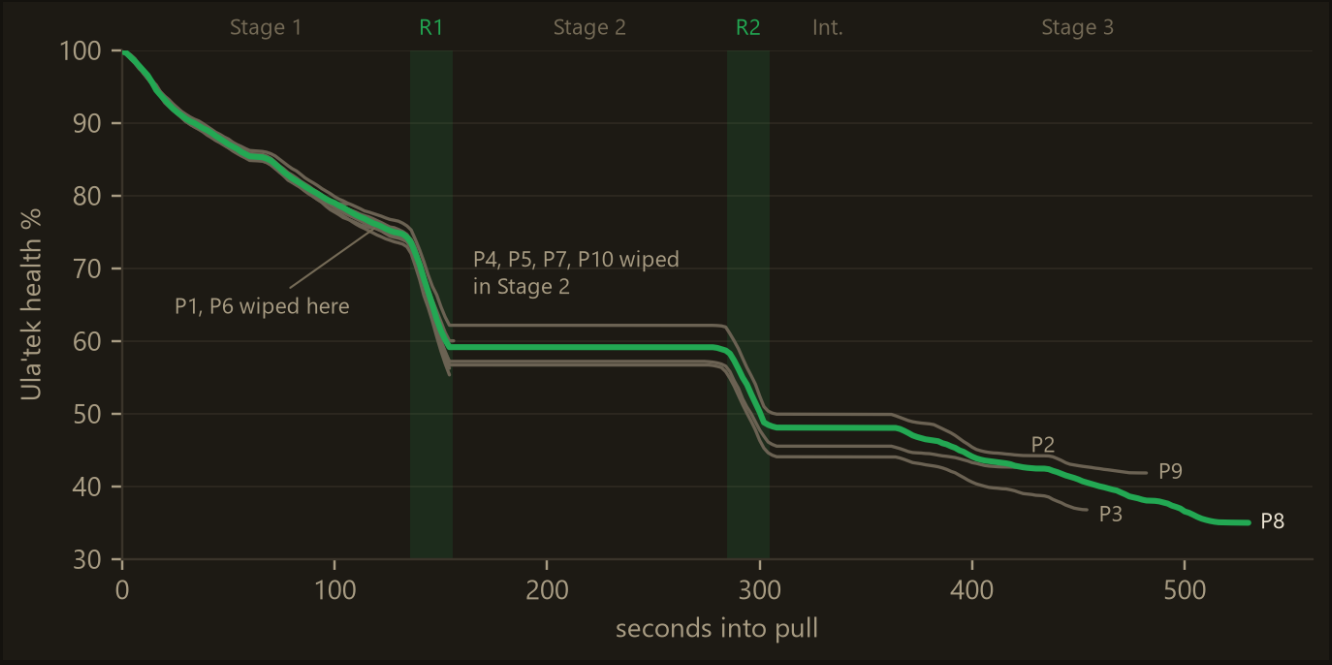
FIX THESE FIRST

1. Leave 4.5 s or more between Grasping Fangs snap sets. **2.** Tail tank taunting by 8 s; taunt her only from melee; her tank never leaves her reach. **3.** A named reserve for any Serpent's Bite group that has lost a member. **4.** Potion of Recklessness inside the first Heart window.

SECTION 1

How the night went

Every pull follows the same script: Stage One in 135 s, a 20-second Heart window, Stage Two, a second window at 284 s, the intermission, then Stage Three on falling platforms. The fight is time-locked: the Heart opens at exactly 135.5 s and 284.5 s on every pull. So any difference between pulls is execution, and the pulls can be compared directly.



Ula'tek's health over time. Stage Two is flat because the boss is untargetable while you fight the wardens. Nearly all the progress comes from Stage One and the two Heart windows.

Every wipe, and what ended it

PULL	LENGTH	REACHED	HP	WHAT ENDED IT
1	122 s	Stage 1	75.5%	Mother's Wrath fired at Parmageddon while he was 55 yd away on the tail. Hyperxd's Growl came 0.2 s before the cast finished, too late. Every bite went raid-wide and 13 players died in 1.6 s.
2	424 s	S3 platform 1	42.7%	Serpent's Bite: Pawsey's circle got 12 helper ticks while the other two got 33 and 53. The melee soaked Blackscale's circle instead. Pawsey became a Calcified Corpse at 408 s, and 14 players were dead 3 s later.
3	456 s	S3 platform 2	36.8%	Parmageddon died under Mother's Wrath at 453.9 s. With the marked tank dead, the bites landed on the raid. Three DPS had already died at 419–424 s to the Volatile Purge DoT plus Caustic Waves.
4	249 s	Stage 2	60.0%	A Viper hatched at 206 s (Putrid Membrane hit the raid 432 times) on top of Blight Vein. The warden lived long enough to cast a second set of Grasping Fangs at 217 s.
5	230 s	Stage 2	56.3%	Five tethers snapped in one unbroken 9-second chain. Blight Vein reached 5 stacks and ticked about 410k every 2 s, and 10 players died between 196 and 208 s.
6	108 s	Stage 1	78.9%	The tail lost its tank twice (Rattler Slam at 87 and 93 s). Parmageddon left the boss to pick it up without Hyperxd taking the boss, so she hit Unchecked Rage at 93 s and five players died instantly.
7	233 s	Stage 2	55.4%	A Viper hatched at 209 s (Putrid Membrane, 14.6M raid damage) while Blight Vein was up, and the raid bled out.

PULL	LENGTH	REACHED	HP	WHAT ENDED IT
8	530 s	S3 platform 3	35.0%	Best pull. Five players died around the second platform break (480–487 s). The third bite's ranged circle then had one helper (Scitolock), and Elladale became a Calcified Corpse at 516 s.
9	484 s	S3 platform 2	41.9%	Unchecked Rage at 407 s (her tank had moved 32 yd out to spread Volatile Purge) killed four, three of them regular soakers of the melee circle. Pawsey's next circle had three helpers and failed at 477 s.
10	224 s	Stage 2	57.2%	Six snaps in one 12-second chain took Blight Vein to 6 stacks, and 14 players died between 201 and 209 s. A Malice also went through at 178.7 s because the second kick was late.

"Helper ticks" are Serpent's Bite soak ticks taken by someone other than the marked player. Each one was assigned to the nearest marked player using the positions in the log. A Calcified Corpse on this difficulty hits the whole raid, and in this log it ended all three pulls it appeared in.

SECTION 2

Are people hitting the Heart?

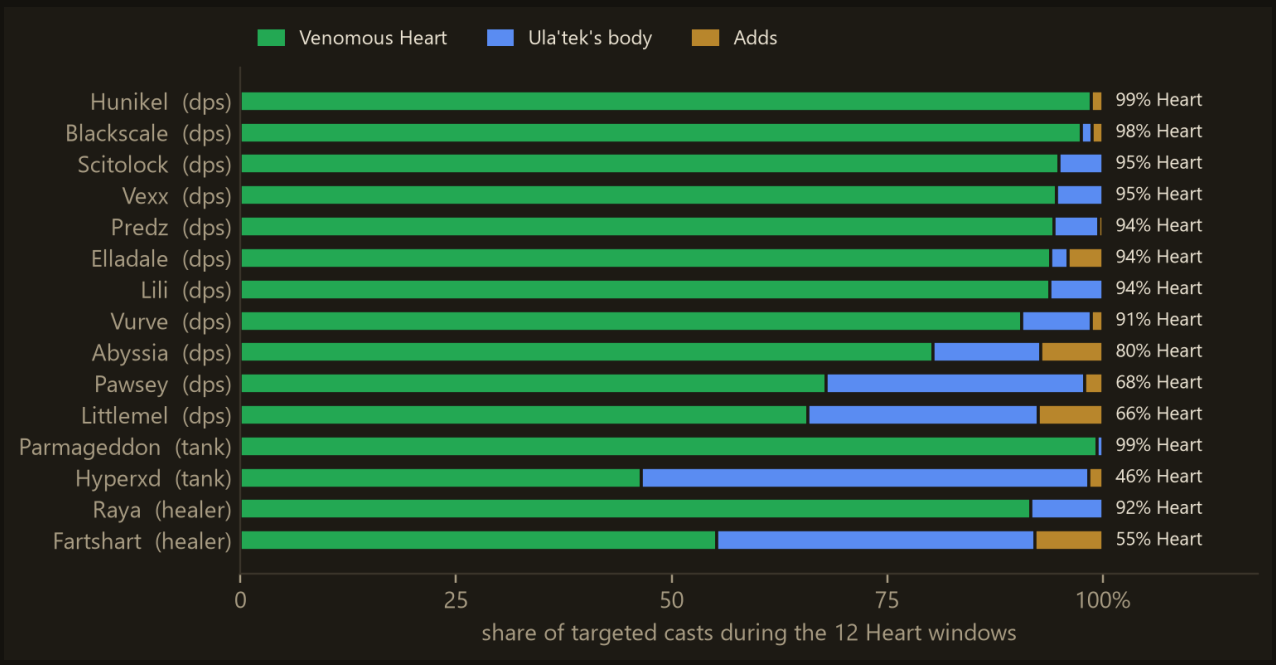
Mostly yes. Rage of the Shackled exposes the Venomous Heart for 20 seconds, and the log confirms it shares Ula'tek's health pool (both show 873,983,280 HP). The Compendium says the Heart takes 100% more damage. The log agrees: the same player's same spell hit the Heart for **1.96×** what it did to the body in those windows (median across 65 player-spell pairs). So every global spent on the body during a window is half a global wasted.

16.3%
average boss HP removed in the first Heart window (range 13.7–18.1%)

10.8%
average removed in the second window (4 pulls got there)

10 / 15
players with 90%+ of their targeted casts on the Heart

≤1.4%
worst-case boss HP lost to body hits in any one window



Measured from what each cast was aimed at (the target recorded on every SPELL_CAST_SUCCESS), not from where the damage landed. That separates a mis-targeted cast from a cleave proc that spills onto the body. Untargeted AoE casts are left out. Mishamigo (Holy Priest) cast fewer than 20 damage spells in the windows, so they are not shown.

Windows where someone stayed on the body

These are the player-windows where at least five targeted casts went at the body, and the body got as many casts as the Heart or more. Pawsey (Ret) did it in two windows and Littlemel (Destruction) in three. They are the clear DPS cases. Pawsey's P3 first window had 45 casts at the body and none at the Heart.

PULL · WINDOW	PLAYER	CASTS AT HEART	CASTS AT BODY
P2 · window 1	Hyperxd (tank)	0	12
P3 · window 1	Littlemel (dps)	5	12
P3 · window 1	Pawsey (dps)	0	45
P3 · window 2	Hyperxd (tank)	0	15
P5 · window 1	Hyperxd (tank)	1	15
P8 · window 1	Hyperxd (tank)	0	18
P8 · window 2	Littlemel (dps)	0	15
P9 · window 1	Abyssia (dps)	2	5
P9 · window 1	Hyperxd (tank)	1	17
P9 · window 1	Littlemel (dps)	0	18
P9 · window 2	Hyperxd (tank)	0	14
P9 · window 2	Pawsey (dps)	4	21

Reading the rest of the chart

- **Hyperxd at 46%** is the tank on Ula'tek holding her through the window. Six of their twelve windows went almost entirely on the body. That may be a threat habit rather than a mistake. While she channels Rage of the Shackled she is not meleeing, so Unchecked Rage cannot fire. Parmageddon, standing at the same distance (7–9 yd from the Heart), put 99% on the Heart with no problems. If nothing in your plan needs the tank on the body, that is free damage.
- **Fartshart at 55%** is a Holy Paladin weaving Judgment and Holy Shock into healing, so it is a small number of casts. Worth a target-of-target or focus macro, but it won't move the boss.
- **Abyssia at 80%**: 9 Disintegrates and 4 Living Flames went at the body across the night. Small, but it is a target swap, not a cleave.
- **Nobody was out of range.** In every window the whole raid stood closer to the Heart than to the body. The Heart sits about 6 yd from her centre, so this is target choice, not reach.

> **WHAT THIS IS WORTH**
>
> Counting *every* single-target hit on the body during a window as a mistake, the raid gave up 0.7–1.4% of boss health per window. That ceiling is generous, because the top contributors (Predz, Vurve) aimed 94% and 91% of their casts at the Heart. Their body damage is cleave procs like Sweeping Strikes, which is correct play. The real mis-targeting cost is a fraction of that, well under 1% of her health per window. Good to collect, but every pull ended for other reasons first.

The bigger lever in the window: potions

Heroism lands at 127–129 s, which is right: it covers the whole window. Potions are a different story. Potion of Recklessness was drunk in the first 10 s by Hunikel, Predz, Vurve, Abyssia and Vexx, and by Parmageddon and Mishamigo in the first 20–40 s. That puts it on cooldown for the first window. Only Blackscale (five pulls) and Abyssia (once) drank one *inside* the first Heart window. Elladale, Lili, Littlemel, Pawsey, Scitolock, Raya and Hyperxd never drank one in any pull (no other combat potion shows up in the log either). Potion damage spent on the Heart counts double, so the window is the best

place for it. The 13.7–18.1% spread in the first window's damage across pulls is bigger than the whole mis-targeting cost.

SECTION 3

Avoidable damage

Personal avoidable damage here means mechanics where the hit belongs to the person hit, according to the Compendium's Heroic page: **Caustic Waves** (each impact; its DoT is counted in the damage), **Virulent Spit**, **Falling Debris**, **Deadly Venom** pools (one exposure per continuous stand-in) and **Desperate Thrash** on a non-tank. Hits fully eaten by an absorb still count. Group failures (Unchecked Rage, Rattler Slam, Putrid Membrane, Calcified Corpse) are covered in section 4, because they land on everyone and belong to whoever caused them.

	P1 122s	P2 423s	P3 456s	P4 248s	P5 230s	P6 108s	P7 233s	P8 530s	P9 483s	P10 224s
Hyperxd	1	5	7	5	7	3	5	10	7	4
Parmageddon	3	2	8	2	3	2	3	7	5	2
Pawsey	·	4	2	2	1	1	·	4	3	3
Fartshart	1	2	·	4	2	·	1	3	2	1
Predz	·	1	4	1	·	·	·	4	4	·
Littlemel	·	·	2	1	2	·	·	5	2	·
Elladale	1	2	3	1	1	·	·	2	2	·
Raya	·	·	2	1	2	1	1	3	2	·
Lili	·	·	·	3	1	1	·	4	2	·
Abyssia	·	·	1	4	·	2	·	1	2	·
Vurve	·	·	1	·	·	·	1	3	3	·
Scitolock	1	·	1	·	·	1	1	3	1	·
Mishamigo	1	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	5	1
Blackscale	·	1	1	1	·	·	3	·	1	·
Vexx	1	1	·	·	·	·	·	2	3	·
Hunikel	·	·	1	1	·	·	·	1	1	·

Personal avoidable hits per player per pull, sorted by total. A dot means none. Pull length is under each column, and long pulls naturally collect more, which is why the table below normalises by time alive.

Top offenders, normalised

PLAYER	ROLE	HITS	PER 10 MIN ALIVE	PER PULL (MEAN ± SD)	RANGE	DAMAGE
Hyperxd	tank	54	10.9	5.4 ± 2.4	1–10	29.3M
Parmageddon	tank	37	7.3	3.7 ± 2.1	2–8	21.0M
Pawsey	dps	20	4.1	2.0 ± 1.4	0–4	13.6M
Fartshart	healer	16	3.3	1.6 ± 1.2	0–4	11.1M
Predz	dps	14	3.0	1.4 ± 1.7	0–4	7.5M
Littlemel	dps	12	2.5	1.2 ± 1.5	0–5	10.2M
Elladale	dps	12	2.4	1.2 ± 1.0	0–3	4.5M
Raya	healer	12	2.4	1.2 ± 1.0	0–3	7.4M
Lili	dps	11	2.3	1.1 ± 1.4	0–4	4.6M
Abyssia	dps	10	2.1	1.0 ± 1.3	0–4	9.0M
Scitolock	dps	8	1.8	0.8 ± 0.9	0–3	5.7M
Vurve	dps	8	1.7	0.8 ± 1.2	0–3	5.8M
Vexx	dps	7	1.6	0.7 ± 1.0	0–3	5.3M
Mishamigo	healer	8	1.6	0.8 ± 1.5	0–5	6.9M
Blackscale	dps	7	1.4	0.7 ± 0.9	0–3	2.9M
Hunikel	dps	4	0.8	0.4 ± 0.5	0–1	1.9M

How to read it

- **Raid average: 3.1 hits per player per 10 minutes alive.** Per-player standard deviations are 0.5–2.4 hits a pull, so nobody had one disastrous pull. The same few people take the same few hits every time. Stage One plays out identically every pull, and it produced 2–12 personal hits across the whole raid (median 5). The two outliers were P6 (11) and P9 (12), and in P9 a single Caustic Waves set at 52 s caught twelve players.
- **The tanks top the table, and that is partly the job.** Hyperxd and Parmageddon account for 91 of 240 hits. Caustic Waves start at her wings and her tail, which is where the tanks have to stand. Virulent Spit landed on Hyperxd 15 times, mostly in Stage Two, where the tanks are holding wardens. Their numbers are real damage for healers to plan around, but not the same kind of mistake as a DPS walking into a wave.
- **Pawsey is the clear DPS outlier** (4.1 per 10 min, against a non-tank average of 2.2), followed by Fartshart (3.3) and Predz (3.0). Everyone else is between 0.8 and 2.5.
- **Virulent Spit is the one that kills.** At about 420k a hit it lands during the Stage Two Blight Vein peak. It was the killing blow for Raya (P4), Fartshart (P5), Littlemel (P5), Fartshart (P8), Predz (P9), Fartshart (P10), Mishamigo (P10). Fartshart took 9 Spit hits on the night, and died to it three times.

By mechanic

MECHANIC	HITS	DAMAGE	MOST HIT
Caustic Waves	101	105.8M	Hyperxd 20, Parmageddon 18, Pawsey 8, Littlemel 7
Virulent Spit	41	16.3M	Hyperxd 15, Fartshart 9, Raya 3, Predz 2
Falling Debris	38	14.6M	Hyperxd 9, Parmageddon 9, Pawsey 4, Abyssia 3
Deadly Venom (pool)	58	8.9M	Hyperxd 10, Parmageddon 9, Predz 7, Elladale 6
Desperate Thrash (non-tank)	2	1.0M	Pawsey 2
Call of the Serpent (landing) (soft)	24	8.3M	Blackscale 11, Pawsey 6, Hyperxd 3, Littlemel 2
Warden's Protection (soft)	35	6.3M	Hyperxd 8, Scitolock 5, Elladale 4, Littlemel 4

Soft mechanics are not in the ranking: egg catchers may stand under Call of the Serpent drops on purpose (Blackscale takes one almost every pull, which looks like a job), and egg collectors brush Warden's Protection. The raid-wide fall at 359.5 s when the intermission platform shatters is scripted and left out. Caustic Waves is the expensive one: 101 hits for about 1M each once the DoT is included.

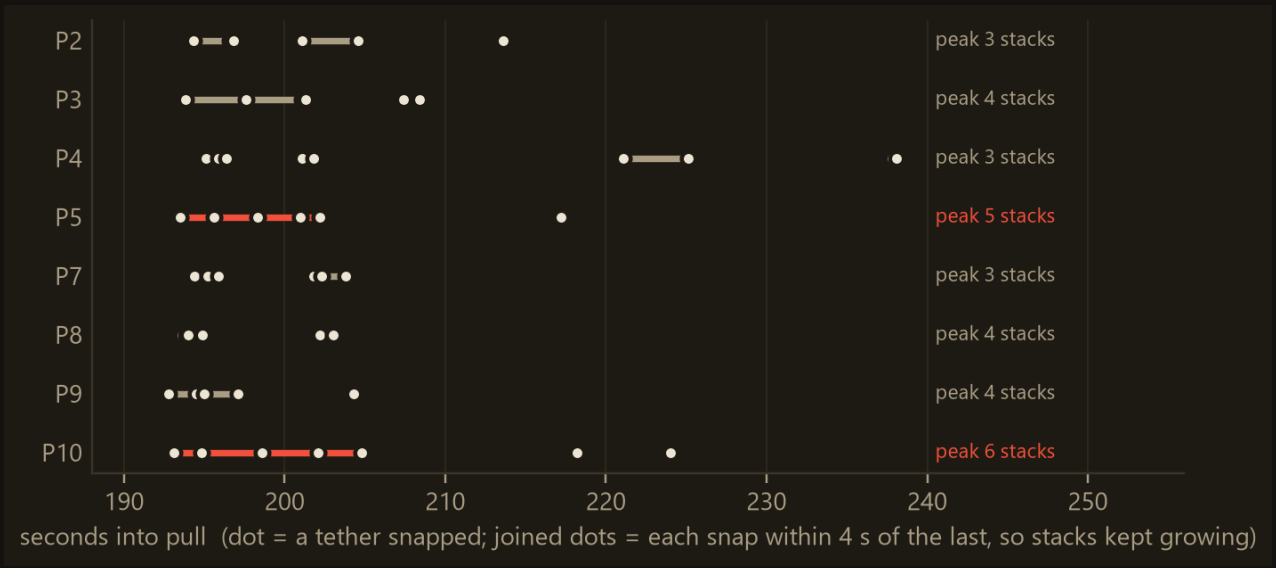
SECTION 4

What is actually ending pulls

Three problems account for nearly all of it, plus two Viper hatches in Stage Two (P4 and P7) that this review flags but does not dissect. In order of cost:

Stage Two: the Grasping Fangs snap schedule

Each Doomscale Warden tethers three players, so six tethers go out at about 190 s. Every snap puts a stack of **Blight Vein** on the whole raid. Here is the fact that matters, measured from 230 clean expiries in the log: **Blight Vein lasts exactly 4.0 seconds after the most recent snap, and every snap refreshes it.** A snap less than 4 s after the previous one adds to the stack. A gap of more than 4 s lets the whole stack fall off. Each stack ticks about 95k on every player every 2 s.



Surviving pulls peaked at 3–4 stacks. P5 and P10 chained five and six snaps with every gap under 4 s, and the raid died at 5–6 stacks (400–500k ticks). P4 and P7 stayed at 3 but lost a Viper hatch at the same moment.

THE FIX

Make the gap the rule, not the count. The Compendium's Heroic plan is to snap two, two, then one and one, with a cooldown on each set. The log adds the timing: **leave at least 4.5 s between sets** so each set starts from zero. Two people snap together, then the next two snap only on a call, after the stack has visibly dropped. In P10, Littlemel, Lili and Abyssia each snapped 2.7–3.8 s after the previous person, which is just inside the window, and that is how six stacks happened.

Stage Three: Serpent's Bite circles left short

Three marks go out and helpers soak the ticks. A healthy circle collects 40–80 helper ticks and clears early (Volatile Purge arrives 8–11 s in). Every failed circle in the log was short of bodies:

PULL · BITE	FAILED CIRCLE	ITS HELPERS (TICKS)	WHY IT WAS SHORT
P2 · 1st	Pawsey	Abyssia 5, Parmageddon 3, Predz 2, healers 2	The melee (Hunikel, Vurve, Hyperxd, Predz) soaked **Blackscale's** circle instead. Group-to-mark assignment broke.
P8 · 3rd	Elladale	Scitolock 46, nobody else	Lili (424 s), then Abyssia, Blackscale and Littlemel (481–487 s), all regular soakers of that circle, were dead. That left the group with one soaker, and nobody refilled it.
P9 · 2nd	Pawsey	Hunikel 19, Hyperxd 7, Parmageddon 7	Vurve and Predz died to Unchecked Rage at 407 s. Both tanks dipped in for 7 ticks each.

THE FIX

Give each soak group a named reserve: someone who moves to the short circle when the group has lost a member. Call it once marks land. Squishei's plan (on the Compendium page) assigns groups before the pull, with healers moving when two circles overlap. Your three wipes show the missing rule: **a group that has lost people borrows from the healthiest group**.

Tank hand-offs

Ula'tek and her tail both punish an empty melee range by hitting the whole raid. The log shows the same few patterns:

WHAT	WHEN	WHAT THE LOG SHOWS
Opening Rattler Slam	P2, P3, P5, P10 at 12.7–14.8 s	The tail surfaces and slams about 0.7 s into its first cast. In the five clean pulls Parmageddon taunted the tail at 6.5–8.3 s. In P2, P3 and P5 the first taunt came at 13.4–15.1 s. About 8M raid damage each time, and in P2 the loose tail meleed Predz to death first.
Ranged taunt swap	P1 and P10 at 38 s, P9 at 70 s	Hand of Reckoning onto Ula'tek from 30–38 yd. Her target is instantly out of reach, so Unchecked Rage fires on the same frame, even with Hyperxd still beside her. Walk in, then taunt. (P9 was the same thing at her resurfacing point after Submerge.)
Tank leaves with aggro	P6 93 s, P8 464 s	P6: Parmageddon left her for the tail without Hyperxd taking her, giving Unchecked Rage plus Rattler Slam and 5 deaths. P8: Parmageddon ran 52 yd to a Rawling while holding the boss.
Current tank steps out	P2 308 s, P9 407 s	Hyperxd, holding her, drifted out to 19+ yd and then 32 yd from her centre (Call of the Serpent and Volatile Purge spreading). In P9 that killed four players, which then broke the next bite circle.
Mother's Wrath raid-wide	P1 119 s, P3 454 s	If the marked tank is out of reach, or dead, every bite goes to the raid. P1 was a late swap: the mark landed on the tail tank. P3 was a tank death under the bites.

THE FIX

Three rules cover every one of them. **The tail tank is at the tail's surfacing point and taunting by 8 s. Taunt her only from inside melee. Whoever holds her never leaves her reach**: if a soak, spread or add needs them, the other tank takes her first, from melee. The Compendium's line for this fight is that Unchecked Rage is "the fight's quietest wipe cause because nothing on screen announces it." Seven of them in one night bears that out.

A note on the damage check

This is not what killed you tonight, but it is coming. Stage One and the Heart windows are healthy: about 0.19% of her health per second in Stage One, and 14–18% in each first window. In Stage Three, boss damage falls to 0.04–0.08% per second, and roughly half of all raid damage goes into adds (Rawlings, Shriekers). The best pull went from 47.7% to 35.0% over three platforms. Some of that is deaths, and the rest is the add load. This log can't say what platform four offers. The Compendium's source calls it the burn where you "sacrifice the soakers". But arriving with more people alive, and the Heart windows full, is what makes the last platform reachable.

Next raid night, in order

- **Blight Vein gaps of at least 4.5 s between snap sets**, called by one person. On the log's evidence this alone would have carried P5 and P10 through Stage Two. P4 and P7 also need the Stage Two eggs handled, because a Viper hatched in both.
- **Tail picked up by 8 s; taunts only from melee; the holder never leaves her reach.** That covers P1, P6 and P9's first collapse, plus 126M of raid-wide damage from untanked hits across the night.
- **Serpent's Bite reserves**: when a soak group loses a member, a named player from another group moves to its circle. This would have prevented P2, P8 and P9.
- **Potion of Recklessness inside the first Heart window** for everyone who can, instead of pre-pull or not at all.
- **Pawsey, Littlemel, Hyperxd: Heart macro or focus target** for the two windows. Pawsey and Fartshart: Caustic Waves and Virulent Spit awareness in Stage Two.

Method and caveats

Source: the in-game combat log (advanced logging, build 12.1.5), 10 encounters of Ula'tek (encounter 3492), Heroic, 16 players. Everything was parsed from raw events with a stdlib Python script. Mechanics were classified using the Compendium's Ula'tek page (Encounter Journal plus Squishei's Heroic guide). That page notes the strategy is single-sourced, and so is the avoidable/unavoidable split here.

Heart windows: 135.5–155.5 s and 284.5–304.5 s on every pull, from the Rage of the Shackled cast, and matching the first and last Heart damage to within 0.1 s. Targeting uses cast targets. The damage-cost ceiling uses hits the log itself flags single-target ("ST"), so AoE and DoTs are excluded. Melee is counted once: the log writes every swing twice (SWING_DAMAGE and SWING_DAMAGE_LANDED).

Circle membership for Serpent's Bite is inferred from last-known positions and assigned to the nearest marked player, so treat single ticks as approximate. The big gaps (12 helper ticks against 33 and 53, one helper against four) are not sensitive to that. Positions come from the log's own coordinates. Distances are close to yards but not exact, given her large hitbox.

Not attempted: healing and cooldown audits, interrupt coverage beyond Malice, and the Doomscale egg delivery. Those would be the next pass if Stage Two keeps being the wall.